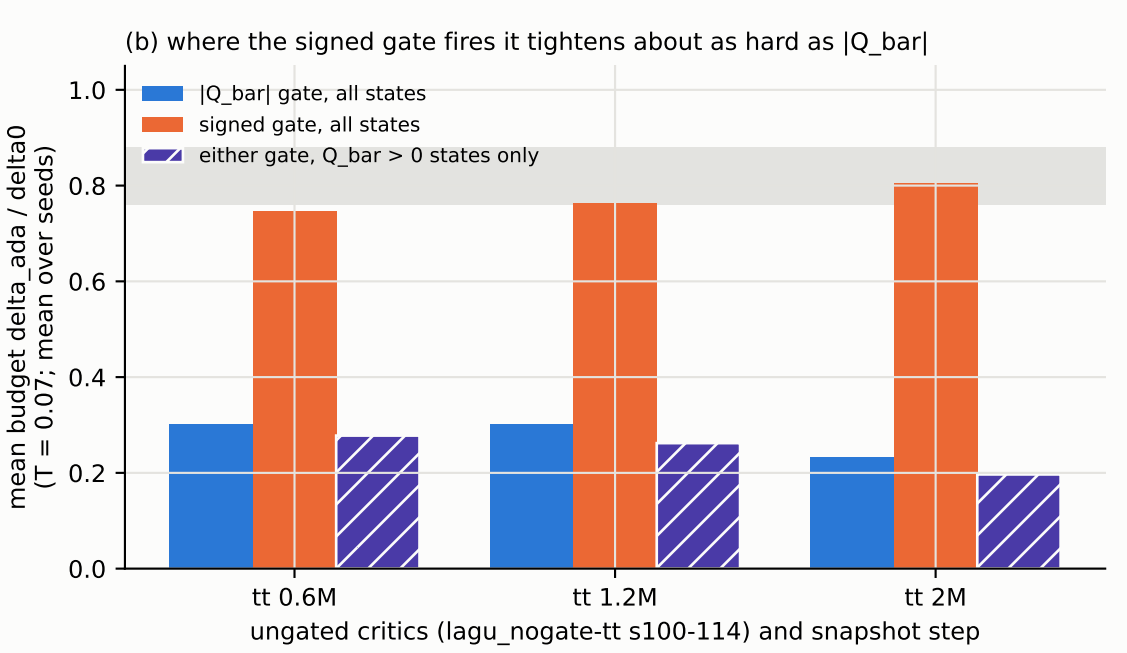EXPLORATORY (verification): the signed-gate average is a mixture of ungated states and heavily tightened states
5 held-out layouts x 1000 on-policy states per snapshot; static counterfactual on ungated critics